

Brand guidelines

*Construction project management
for the site engineer.*



MHANDISI MAKINI

A practical identity for clear planning, responsible action and visible progress.

Version 1.1 • September 2026

Based on the selected hard hat, gear and checkmark concept. Brand meaning and tagline confirmed by the founder. Other design rules are proposed standards. Screen examples illustrate design intent, not confirmed app functionality.

01 / FOUNDATION

Built for the site engineer

MHANDISI MAKINI is Swahili for “Very Keen Engineer”. The brand expresses attentiveness, precision and care in construction project management. Its collaborative promise is captured in the tagline: “Let's build together”.

Positioning

For site engineers managing day-to-day construction work, MHANDISI MAKINI is a project management app designed to bring project information, responsibilities and progress into a clear working view.

Purpose, mission and ambition

Purpose: help site engineers stay organised and act with confidence.

Mission: make everyday project coordination clearer and more accountable.

Ambition: become a trusted digital companion for construction teams, beginning with the site engineer.

Who we serve

Primary audience: site engineers coordinating work on site. Secondary audiences may include project managers, supervisors and contractors who receive or act on project information. Address the engineer first; keep shared reports understandable to the wider team.

Pillar	Brand behaviour
Clarity	Present the current situation and the next action.
Precision	Use exact dates, units, labels and ownership.
Accountability	Show who is responsible and what needs follow-up.
Practicality	Respect the pace and conditions of site work.

Brand personality

Capable, attentive, composed and direct. The brand should feel like an organised professional colleague. Avoid boastful claims, playful construction cartoons and unnecessarily technical language.

02 / LOGO

One mark. Three meanings.

The selected symbol combines the engineer's hard hat, an operational gear and a completion checkmark.



Element	Meaning
Hard hat	Site work, engineering responsibility and practical context.
Gear	Coordination and the moving parts of a construction project.
Checkmark	Follow-through, progress and completed work.
Wordmark	A bold, stable signature that names the product clearly.

Primary signature

Use the supplied stacked logo as the primary signature. Keep the icon above the two-line uppercase name. Preserve the exact spelling MHANDISI MAKINI, existing alignment and relative proportions. Treat the image as a single asset; do not retype its wordmark.

Asset status: the selected logo is a raster concept. A clean vector master and separately exported icon, horizontal and monochrome variants remain production deliverables; they are specified here but are not supplied as finished logo assets.

03 / LOGO RULES

Protect recognition

Apply these rules to every placement, from a mobile launch screen to a printed report.

Clear space

Let X equal the visible height of the yellow hard-hat brim. Keep at least 2X of empty space on every side of the visible logo artwork, including below the wordmark.

Measure from the artwork, not the edges of its image canvas. Increase space where nearby content is visually busy.

Minimum size

For the complete stacked logo, use a starting minimum width of 160 px on screen or 35 mm in print. For a future icon-only master, start at 32 px or 10 mm. These are provisional production limits: test the actual exported asset at final size and enlarge it if the letters, checkmark or gear gaps lose clarity.

Placement	Rule
White or very pale background	Use the primary yellow-and-charcoal signature.
Dark background	Place the primary logo on a white holding panel with full clear space until a reversed master exists.
Photography	Use a plain white panel; keep away from busy details.
Single-colour printing	Use an approved one-colour master when produced; do not rely on automatic grayscale conversion.
App icon / favicon	Use a dedicated symbol-only export when produced. Never squeeze the full name into a tiny square.

Never alter the logo

Do not stretch, rotate, recolour, add shadows, change the wordmark, move the checkmark, separate the hat from the gear, or place a slogan inside the mark. Do not use the checkmark as evidence that a safety inspection or technical approval occurred.

Variant construction brief

Future horizontal lockup: symbol on the left, name on the right, optically centred with a 2X gap. Future app tile: charcoal square, simplified yellow/white symbol, central safe area of roughly 70% of the canvas. Review all new masters alongside the primary signature.

04 / COLOUR

Yellow with purpose

Charcoal carries authority and legibility. Yellow draws attention to the brand and the most important action. White gives information room to breathe.



Colour	RGB	CMYK*	Use
Site Yellow #FFBE00	255, 190, 0	0, 25, 100, 0	Brand accent; primary action fill
Charcoal #292D30	41, 45, 48	15, 6, 0, 81	Text, headings, dark surfaces
White #FFFFFF	255, 255, 255	0, 0, 0, 0	Main surfaces and clear space
Concrete #F5F6F7	245, 246, 247	1, 0, 0, 3	Page background and panels
Slate #56616B	86, 97, 107	20, 9, 0, 58	Secondary text

*CMYK values are approximate conversions, not press specifications. Proof on the intended stock and adjust through the printer's colour workflow. The hex values define the proposed digital palette; the raster concept may contain small colour variations.

Colour balance

Aim for 70% white or pale neutral, 20% charcoal and 10% yellow in general communications. This is a composition guide, not a quota. Dense app screens should use less decorative yellow.

Legible pairings

Use charcoal text on yellow, white text on charcoal, and charcoal or slate text on white. Do not use white text on yellow or yellow text on white for essential content. Pair every status colour with a readable label and, where helpful, an icon.

05 / TYPOGRAPHY

Readable at the point of work

Use a restrained sans-serif hierarchy. The logo lettering is artwork and is separate from the type system used in the app and communications.

Let's build together

Project overview

Daily site report

Record progress. Assign responsibility. Keep the next step clear.

Primary family

Proposed brand font: DejaVu Sans. Use Regular for body text, Bold for headings and critical labels. Use a single family consistently. Arial is the office-document fallback when the brand font is unavailable; a system sans-serif stack is the app fallback.

Role	App / web	Print
Hero / campaign headline	32–40 px Bold	28–34 pt Bold
Page title	28 px Bold	24–27 pt Bold
Section heading	20 px Bold	15–18 pt Bold
Body	16 px Regular; 1.5 line height	11 pt; 1.15–1.3 line height
Label / metadata	14 px Regular or Bold	9–10 pt Regular

Typesetting rules

Use sentence case for headings, buttons and navigation. Reserve uppercase for the logo and short category labels. Left-align working content; centre only short cover or campaign titles. Avoid condensed type, italics for long passages and paragraphs set entirely in capitals.

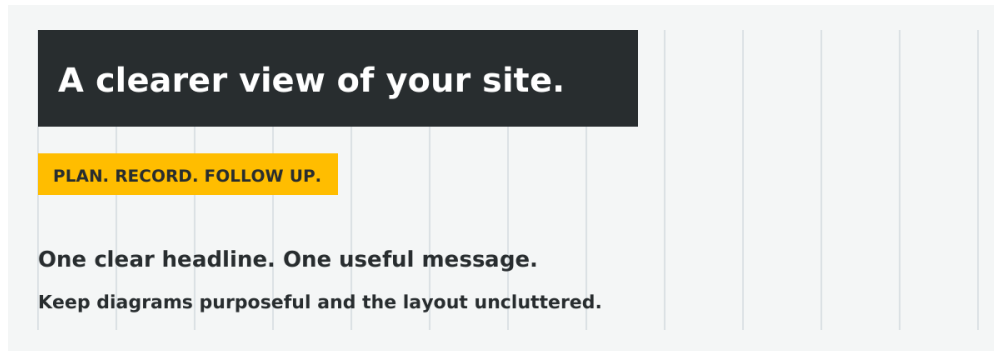
Data and localisation

Keep units next to values: 25 m², 12 mm, TZS 150,000. Use unambiguous dates such as 06 Sep 2026. Align numerical columns consistently. Allow text to wrap naturally in English and Swahili without truncating essential instructions.

06 / VISUAL LANGUAGE

Order without clutter

The visual system takes its structure from plans and site records: clean alignment, useful annotation and deliberate emphasis.



Grids and spacing

Use an 8 px base spacing unit for digital layouts, with 4 px for small adjustments. Start mobile pages with 16 px outer margins; use 24–32 px on larger screens. Keep related information close and separate major sections with at least 24 px. In print, use generous margins and consistent left alignment.

Icons and graphic elements

Use simple engineering-inspired outline icons on a 24 px grid with approximately 2 px strokes. Match stroke weight, corner treatment and optical size across the set. Use familiar symbols for reports, tasks, people and project information. Label unfamiliar icons. The brand mark is not the default icon for every feature.

Photography direction

Show real construction activity, attentive engineers, plans, materials and documented progress. Choose clear compositions and natural lighting. Depict suitable protective equipment for the visible work. Avoid staged handshakes, unrelated skyscrapers and photographs that obscure the subject with heavy effects.

Patterns and diagrams

Use faint blueprint grids, linework or restrained yellow bands as secondary elements. Keep them behind nonessential areas and away from small text. Draw technical diagrams accurately; decorative drawings should never resemble approved construction details.

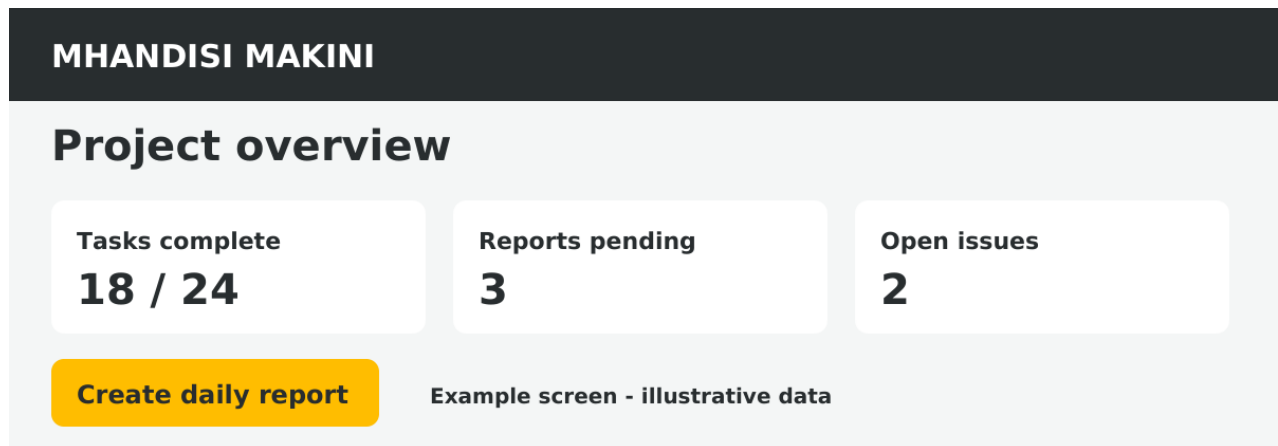
Image treatment

Prefer natural colours and clean crops. Obtain appropriate permission for people, projects and client information. Label illustrative or staged material when its context could otherwise be misleading.

07 / PRODUCT EXPERIENCE

Make the next action clear

Brand consistency in the app means readable information, predictable controls and honest feedback.



Illustrative dashboard only; feature names and values are examples.

Component	Proposed rule
Primary action	Yellow fill, charcoal bold label; one dominant action per view.
Secondary action	White fill, charcoal border and text.
Cards	White surface, subtle border, 8 px corner radius, 16 px internal padding.
Inputs	Persistent label, visible border, helper text and error message below.
Interaction	Use a 48 × 48 px target as the internal design target. Provide a visible keyboard focus state.
Navigation	Stable labels and icon positions; indicate the active section with more than colour.

Status palette

Success: #18794E. Warning: #8A5800. Error: #B42318. Information: #175CD3. Use these for meaning, not decoration. Keep brand yellow distinct from warning messages by using explicit labels such as “Action needed” or “Overdue”.

Feedback and accessibility

Show progress, empty states and recovery actions in plain language. Never say “Saved” or “Submitted” before confirmation. If local saving and syncing exist, distinguish them. Support text resizing and screen-reader labels; test contrast, focus and touch interaction in the implemented app.

08 / VOICE

Precise. Helpful. Human.

Write like a capable colleague who knows the site engineer has limited time. Start with what happened or what the user needs to do.

Name and language

Use MHANDISI MAKINI in formal brand references. Use Mhandisi Makini in running prose if title case is needed. Keep the name unchanged in English and Swahili. Match the selected interface language throughout each screen; do not switch languages without a reason.

Official tagline and core messaging

Official tagline: “Let's build together”

Use this exact wording, sentence case and apostrophe. It expresses collaboration between the engineer and the people involved in delivering a construction project. Keep it in English unless a separate translation is approved. Place it outside the logo's clear space.

Short description: “Construction project management for the site engineer.”

Swahili description: “Usimamizi wa miradi ya ujenzi kwa mhandisi wa eneo la kazi.”

Moment	English	Swahili
Primary action	Create daily report	Andaa ripoti ya siku
Confirmed save	Report saved.	Ripoti imehifadhiwa.
Required field	Enter the project name.	Weka jina la mradi.
Empty state	No tasks yet. Add your first task.	Hakuna kazi bado. Ongeza kazi yako ya kwanza.
Failed submission	Report not submitted. Try again.	Ripoti haijatumwa. Jaribu tena.

Writing rules

Use active verbs, specific nouns and short sentences. Describe the problem and a useful next step. Avoid blame, exaggerated urgency, jargon and unsupported promises such as “zero delays”, “guaranteed safety” or “perfect project control”. Review Swahili terminology with intended users before release.

09 / APPLICATIONS

One identity across the job

Every application should preserve the same hierarchy: brand, purpose, essential information, then next action.

App launch and sign-in

Use a white launch screen with the primary signature and generous clear space. On sign-in, keep the logo secondary to the form. Use the yellow primary button with a charcoal label. Avoid using a slogan where an instruction would help more.

Reports and document covers

Place the primary logo at the upper left or centred on a cover, above the minimum print size. Follow with report title, project name, report date, author and revision. Use charcoal headings, white pages and small yellow accents. Add page numbers and project identification to long reports. Keep status and approval fields explicit.

Social media and launch materials

For a square 1080 × 1080 composition, keep important text within an inset of at least 64 px. Use one headline, one clear visual and one call to action. Example headline: “A clearer view of your site.” Supporting line: “Construction project management for the site engineer.” Use “Join the waitlist” only if a working waitlist exists.

Site signage and workwear

Use the full signature where reading distance permits. Place it on a plain panel with generous clear space. For embroidery or small helmet decals, commission a simplified production master and proof the gear gaps and checkmark at actual size. Keep branding away from required safety markings and equipment identification.

Partner branding

Give each logo its own clear space. Align logos by perceived visual weight, not identical image-box dimensions. Separate partner identities with space or a subtle divider. Describe each relationship accurately; do not imply an endorsement or certification.

10 / HANDOVER

Keep the system consistent

Use this guide as version 1.1 of the proposed identity system. Maintain one authoritative set of approved logo files and shared design tokens.

Production asset checklist

Commission a faithful vector reconstruction of the selected mark, with outlined wordmark lettering. Export primary stacked, horizontal, icon-only, black and reversed variants as SVG and PDF; export transparent PNGs at practical digital sizes. Test the smallest outputs and printed samples before making them official.

Suggested file names

mhandisi-makini-logo-stacked-colour-v1.svg
mhandisi-makini-logo-horizontal-colour-v1.svg
mhandisi-makini-symbol-colour-v1.svg
mhandisi-makini-logo-mono-black-v1.pdf
mhandisi-makini-app-icon-1024-v1.png

The names above specify a future production package. This delivery contains the guide in PDF and editable Word format, with the selected raster concept embedded. It does not include those vector or variant files.

Review before release

Check exact brand spelling; approved logo variant; clear space and legibility; correct colour values; consistent typography; readable buttons and status labels; accurate dates and units; appropriate image permissions; and claims that match the implemented product.

Ownership and updates

Assign one brand owner to approve new logo masters, palette changes, taglines and external campaign templates. Designers and developers should use a shared component and token source. Record the version, date, reason and approver for each revision; archive superseded assets so they cannot be mistaken for current files.

Decisions to confirm

Confirm the proposed typeface, appoint the brand owner, and complete the production logo masters. The brand meaning and English tagline are confirmed in version 1.1. Validate bilingual interface language and real-device usability with site engineers before launch.

Guide map: foundation; logo and usage; colour; typography; visual language; product experience; voice; applications; handover; visual references; illustrated do/don't examples.

11 / REFERENCE BOARD

The identity in context

Visual references show how the yellow-and-charcoal identity can carry from daily documents to physical site environments.



AI-generated application concepts: helmet, polo shirt, report cover and site sign. These illustrate placement and material direction; reproduce the exact approved artwork from master files, not from these mockups. Incidental background text is not brand messaging.

What to carry forward

White surfaces protect logo clarity. Charcoal provides a stable backdrop for information. Yellow stays concentrated in the symbol and selected accents. On garments, a white patch provides a consistent field for the complete signature.

Tagline placement

Use “Let's build together” as supporting copy on covers, signage and campaigns. Keep it visually smaller than the brand name and outside the logo clear space. On small applications, omit the tagline when it would become difficult to read.

12 / LOGO EXAMPLES

Give the signature room

DO: keep the logo intact and leave space around it. DON'T: allow headlines, labels or decorative text to compete with the mark.

DO



DON'T



Do

Place the signature on a quiet surface with clear space on every side. The dashed green box is an explanatory guide only; it must not appear in the final artwork. Keep the tagline visually separate from the complete logo.

Don't

Do not overlay urgent labels or place headlines across the symbol. Avoid crowding the brand into a corner or filling its clear space with report titles, partner marks or campaign copy.

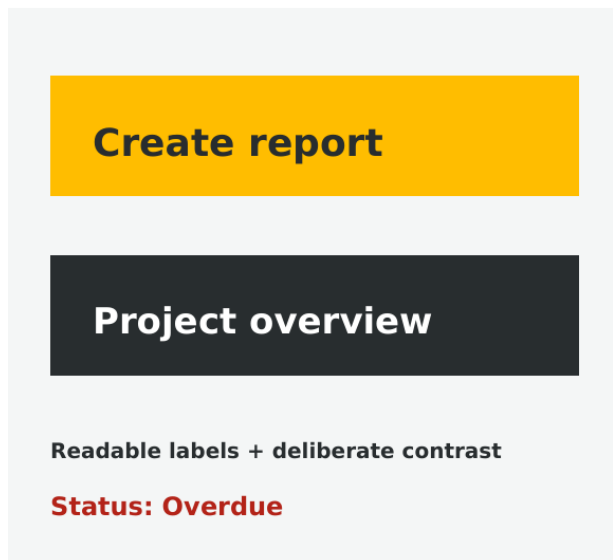
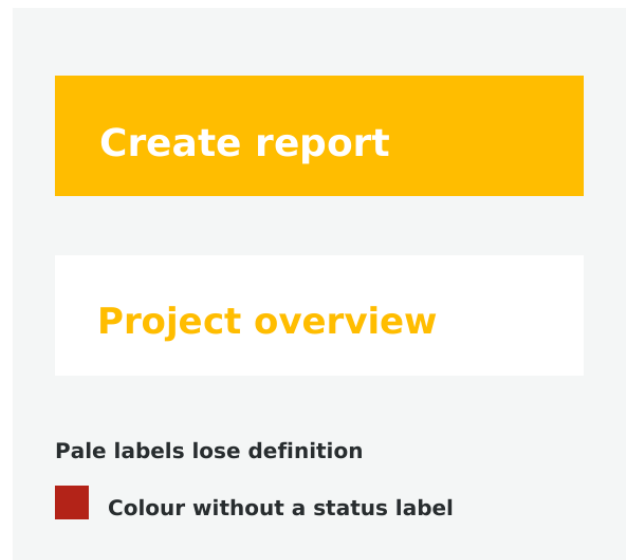
Before exporting

View the placement at actual size. Confirm that the two-line brand name remains readable and the checkmark is distinct. Clear-space measurements follow Section 03; the diagram demonstrates the principle rather than a measured production drawing.

13 / COLOUR EXAMPLES

Make contrast visible

DO: choose combinations that keep essential text readable. DON'T: use yellow and white together for important labels.

DO**DON'T****Do**

Use charcoal text on yellow buttons and white text on charcoal panels. Use the same primary action styling throughout the app. Pair coloured statuses with labels such as "Overdue", "Complete" or "Action needed".

Don't

Avoid white button labels on yellow, yellow body text on white and status dots without words. Colour alone must not carry the meaning of a warning, completion state or error.

In practice

The negative examples are intentionally hard to read. Keep them out of production assets. Check real screens in bright conditions and verify text contrast and focus visibility during implementation.

14 / TYPE EXAMPLES

Create a reading order

DO: establish a clear hierarchy from title to supporting detail. DON'T: make every line bold, oversized and uppercase.

DO

Daily site report

Project: Site A

06 Sep 2026

Progress today

Record completed work and the next action.

A clear reading order

DON'T

DAILY SITE REPORT

PROJECT: SITE A

06 SEP 2026

PROGRESS TODAY

RECORD COMPLETED WORK

Every line competes for attention

Do

Use a strong heading, quieter project details and a readable body size. Group related information. Sentence case makes long headings and working instructions easier to scan. Use regular weight for paragraphs and bold selectively.

Don't

Avoid visual shouting, inconsistent font sizes and equally prominent date, title and body text. Do not shrink important content to fit a fixed box; allow wrapping or adjust the layout.

Brand name versus body text

The uppercase logo remains unchanged. Use the brand's approved artwork for the signature, and the separate type system for reports, interface labels and supporting messages.

15 / INTERFACE EXAMPLES

Guide the next step

DO: label fields and make the main action obvious. DON'T: ask the engineer to interpret vague controls or technical error codes.

DO

Daily report

Project name

Site A

Submit report

Required fields are labelled

One clear action and useful labels

DON'T

Daily report

Enter something...

Continue **Submit**

Error 1042

Ambiguous fields and competing actions

Do

Keep labels visible above fields. Give the main button a specific verb and object, such as “Submit report”. Show errors near the relevant field and explain how to recover. Use the same spacing and button treatment on related screens.

Don't

Do not replace labels with temporary placeholders, show two equally prominent actions with unclear differences, or expose raw error codes as the only explanation. Avoid a success message until the action is confirmed.

Useful recovery copy

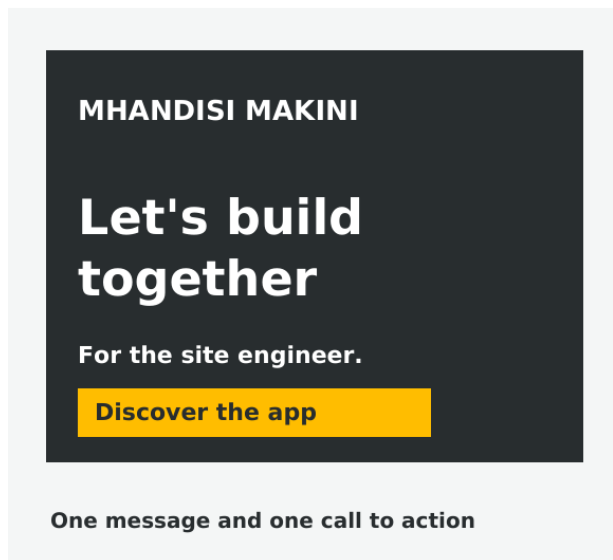
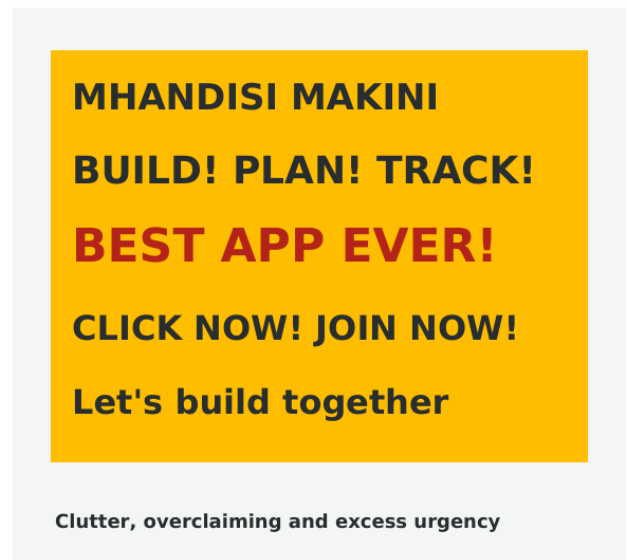
Prefer “Report not submitted. Check your connection and try again.” when a connection failure is confirmed. For an unknown failure, use “Report not submitted. Try again.” Do not guess the cause of an error.

Illustrations are schematic examples of visual and writing rules, not working app screens.

16 / CAMPAIGN EXAMPLES

Invite people to build together

DO: centre the official collaborative message and one clear action. DON'T: combine unsupported claims, repeated calls to action and excessive urgency.

DO**DON'T****Do**

Lead with “Let's build together”. Support it with a short description aimed at the site engineer. Use one relevant destination for the call to action. In these diagrams the typed name is a layout placeholder; use the approved logo in production artwork.

Don't

Avoid “best app ever”, competing calls to action, heavy blocks of uppercase copy and decorative yellow across every surface. Never present unverified claims about savings, safety or project outcomes as facts.

Version 1.1 change record

Confirmed brand meaning: “Very Keen Engineer”. Confirmed tagline: “Let's build together”. Added a four-application reference board and five illustrated do/don't pages. Earlier proposed taglines have been retired. The source raster logo is preserved.